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**WITH
DETERMINED
EXECUTION,
INDIA'S TOP
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FOREIGN
STUDENT RATIO
FROM UNDER
2-3% TO 10-15%
WITHIN
FIVE YEARS**

GLOBALISING B-SCHOOLS

India's top B-schools need to position themselves as global destinations by bridging gaps between policy and perception

INDIA'S MANAGEMENT EDUCATION has come a long way—from a handful of institutes in the 1960s to more than 3,500 today. Our B-schools have fuelled India Inc., created global CEOs, and elevated managerial talent across sectors. Yet one frontier remains underdeveloped: internationalisation.

Despite excellence in pedagogy, infrastructure, and placements, India's top institutes attract only a handful of foreign students. While global peers such as Harvard, Wharton, and INSEAD get 35–95% international students, even the best Indian schools hover around 2–3%. Some programmes call themselves “Global MBAs” or hold the Triple Crown accreditations (AACSB, EQUIS and AMBA) but still lag global standards.

This reflects gaps in policy, perception, and positioning. India needs to position its campuses as global destinations.

Global Classrooms

Leading international B-schools achieve diversity in both students and faculty. For instance, INSEAD and London Business School have about 88% international faculty. Such diversity enriches curricula, research, and the global credibility that attracts applicants.

Even if large-scale foreign hiring takes time, Indian B-schools can be-

gin by inviting visiting professors for specialised modules and collaborate on research.

The real question is no longer whether students abroad are interested in India—they are—but whether our system can convert that interest into enrolment.

This comes at a time when global MBA applications rose 12% in 2024, reversing three years of decline, according to the Graduate Management Admission Council. Asia emerged as the fastest-growing region, and India recorded double-digit growth.

Yet, foreign enrolments remain negligible, revealing a sharp conversion gap between intent and outcome at Indian B-schools.

Where the Gaps Lie

- Unlike the US, the UK or Canada, India lacks a clear post-study work visa for foreign graduates, a decisive factor for Western aspirants.
- Harvard and INSEAD are global shorthand for excellence, built through alumni reach, international research, and employer confidence. Indian institutions are catching up: IIM Ahmedabad, IIM Bangalore, Indian School of Business, and IIM Calcutta along with few others regularly feature in global rankings, but sustained recognition demands stronger branding and consistency.
- Accreditations such as AACSB,